

History Battlefield Tour

Ypres & The Salient



Meoncross School – Battlefield Tour

Name: _____

Tutor Group: _____

Pre-Trip Information

What to Pack & Logistics

What to Pack: The Essential Checklist

Please ensure all pupils have the following items packed in a suitable overnight bag (no hard suitcases if possible, to maximize coach storage space):

- **Valid Passport** (will be given in hopefully at the parent briefing meeting on the 10th of September)
- **GHIC / EHIC Card** (valid and in-date)
- **Sturdy Walking Boots** or waterproof shoes (we will be walking through muddy trenches)
- **Waterproof Coat** (Belgian weather is unpredictable)
- **Small Rucksack** for daytime use on the coach
- **Euro Currency** (approx €30-€50 maximum for snacks and chocolates)
- **Refillable Water Bottle**

Time	Activity / Location	Details
10th Sep	Parent Briefing Meeting	16:15 in the School Hall. Attendance is highly recommended to receive final itineraries and ask any questions.

Day 1: Thursday 1st October 2026

Travel and Initial Explorations

Introduction

Today we travel to Belgium to begin our exploration of the Ypres Salient. The itinerary is packed with important historical sites.

Time	Activity / Location	Details
06:15	Departure from School	Travel via Jet Connect executive coach to Folkestone.
09:00	Folkestone Eurotunnel Terminal	Check-in and security boarding.
11:20	Eurotunnel Crossing	Transit to Calais (clocks go forward 1 hour).
13:00	Depart Calais	Coach journey to the Ypres Salient.
14:30	Essex Farm Cemetery & Dressing Station	Historical introduction to wartime medical care and Commonwealth war graves.
15:15	Langemarck German Military Cemetery	Guided visit exploring the contrasting design of German burial sites.
16:00	Hooze Crater Museum & Trenches	Museum visit focusing on First World War artefacts, preserved trenches, and field medicine. Visit official website.
17:45	Arrival at Peace Village	Accommodation check-in and safety briefing. View hostel details.
18:15	Evening Meal	Dinner followed by room allocation and settling in.
19:15	Study & Reflection Session	Guided review and workbook completion.

Day 2: Friday 2nd October 2026

Immersive Battlefield Study

Overview

Today is a full day of guided study across the Ypres Salient, concluding with the Last Post Ceremony at the Menin Gate.

Time	Activity / Location	Details
08:00	Breakfast	Provided at accommodation.
09:00	Depart for Battlefield Sites	Board coach for full day of guided study.
09:15	The Brooding Soldier	Visit to the Canadian memorial at St Julien (First Gas Attack, 1915).
09:45	Sanctuary Wood & Preserved Trenches	Exploration of original trench systems (sturdy footwear advised).
11:30	Supervised Lunch Stop	Stop in Ypres to purchase packed lunch and snacks.
13:00	Tyne Cot British Cemetery	Guided visit to the world's largest Commonwealth war cemetery.
14:15	Lijssenthoek Visitors Centre & Cemetery	Study of casualty clearing stations and battlefield medicine. Visit official website.
15:45	Passchendaele Museum (Zonnebeke)	Immersive museum tour and dugout experience. Visit official website.
17:30	Return to Peace Village	Downtime and preparation for evening event.
18:00	Evening Meal	Dinner at accommodation.

Day 3: Saturday 3rd October 2026

Poperinge and the Journey Home

Departure

Our final day involves exploring the town of Poperinge, an important rest center for British soldiers, before beginning our journey home.

Time	Activity / Location	Details
08:00	Breakfast & Packing	Breakfast, room handover, and loading coach.
09:15	Menin Gate & Ramparts Walk	Daytime study of memorial panels and walk to Ypres Ramparts Cemetery.
10:30	Ypres Town Square	Supervised visit to a traditional Belgian chocolatier.
11:20	Talbot House, Poperinge	Tour of the famous British soldiers' rest house and club. Visit official website.
12:45	Lunch in Poperinge	Supervised lunch stop in the town centre.
13:30	Poperinge Town Hall	Visit to preserved death cells and military justice sites.
14:30	Depart for Calais	Return journey to Eurotunnel terminal.
17:50	Eurotunnel Crossing	Calais to Folkestone (arrives 17:30 UK time).
20:00 approx.	Return to School	Arrival back at Meoncross School for collection.

My Reflections: Day 3: Saturday 3rd October 2026

Private T. J. Franklin

Local Hero

Private T. J. Franklin

Service Number: 8560
Regiment: 1st Battalion, The Hampshire Regiment
Born: Alverstoke, Hampshire, in about 1893.

Local Connection: He was the son of George Franklin (an Army Pensioner and farm labourer) and Mary Ann Jane Franklin. The family lived at Chark Cottage in Stubbington, and later moved to Meadow Cottage, Chark, Lee-on-the-Solent. By 1911, Thomas was serving in Wellington Lines, Aldershot.

Military Service & Fate: Enlisted at Gosport. He was deployed to the Western Front in August 1914, earning the 1914 Star. He was killed in action on **29th April 1915** during the Second Battle of Ypres. His battalion was holding an exposed section of the line on the Frezenberg Ridge (east of St Julien) to cover an Allied withdrawal, enduring intense German shelling and the first ever military poison gas attacks.

Memorial Site: Commemorated on the Ypres (Menin Gate) Memorial, Belgium (no known grave).

Biographical information courtesy of the Stubbington and Hill Head History Society.

Time	Activity / Location	Details
Home	Stubbington Connection	Lived at Meadow Cottage, Chark
Memorial	Stubbington War Memorial	Commemorated in the village center.
Resting Place	Menin Gate, Ypres	Killed 29th April 1915 holding an exposed line on the Frezenberg Ridge.

Private W. Ayling

Local Hero

Private W. Ayling

Service Number: 9330

Rank: Private (commemorated on the Holy Rood Memorial Tablet as a Lance Corporal, though official war records register him as a Private).

Regiment: 1st Battalion, The Hampshire Regiment

Born: About 1895 in Hindhead, Surrey.

Local Connection: He was the second son of Horace Ayling (a head cowman) and Annie Ayling. The family moved to Stubbington around 1907, residing in a crowded 13-person household in Stubbington Lane, where William worked as a local baker boy.

Military Service & Fate: Enlisted at Winchester. He crossed to France in August 1914, earning the 1914 Star. He was killed by shell fire on **9th July 1915** (only a few months after his battalion comrade, Private Franklin). His company was heavily shelled and hit with trench mortars during an action to relieve captured enemy trenches north of Ypres.

Memorial Site: Commemorated on the Ypres (Menin Gate) Memorial, Belgium (no known grave).

Biographical information courtesy of the Stubbington and Hill Head History Society.

Time	Activity / Location	Details
Home	Stubbington Connection	Lived in Stubbington Lane; worked as a Baker Boy
Memorial	Stubbington War Memorial	Commemorated in the village center.
Resting Place	Menin Gate, Ypres	Killed 9th July 1915 during heavy trench mortar bombardment.

Private S. Muckett

Local Hero

Private S. Muckett

Service Number: 12977

Rank: Private (listed as a Corporal on the Holy Rood Memorial, but registered as a Private in official war records).

Regiment: 15th (Service) Battalion, The Hampshire Regiment

Born: 26th December 1895 at Titchfield.

Local Connection: He was the son of William Muckett (a farm labourer) and Elizabeth Muckett. They lived at Pound Knap, Crofton, and Brown's Farm, Stubbington, where Sydney worked as a grocer's errand boy, before relocating to Melville Gate, Stubbington. His sister Louisa Annie and brother Frank both married into the local Rye family.

Military Service & Fate: Enlisted at Fareham in 1914. He was killed in action, aged 21, on **20th September 1917** during the Battle of Menin Road Ridge. His battalion went over the top south of Ypres, advancing rapidly under fire to clear a German strongpoint at Java Avenue.

Memorial Site: Commemorated on the Tyne Cot Memorial, Belgium (no known grave).

Biographical information courtesy of the Stubbington and Hill Head History Society.

Time	Activity / Location	Details
Home	Stubbington Connection	Lived at Brown's Farm; worked as a Grocer's Errand Boy
Memorial	Stubbington War Memorial	Commemorated in the village center.
Resting Place	Tyne Cot British Cemetery	Killed 20th September 1917 during the Battle of Menin Road Ridge.

Private A. Rye

Local Hero

Private A. Rye

Service Number: 22926

Regiment: 14th Battalion, The Hampshire Regiment

Born: 1897 at Forest Side, Sussex.

Local Connection: He was the youngest child of Charles Rye (a farm labourer) and Jane Rye. The family lived at Stroud Green, Stubbington. By 1911, Arthur was living at Lower Crabthorne, Hill Head, working as a local nurseryman. His sister Alice married Frank Muckett (brother of Private Sydney Muckett).

Military Service & Fate: Enlisted at Fareham. He was killed in action, aged 21, on **26th September 1917**—only nine days after his brother-in-law's brother, Sydney Muckett, was killed. His battalion attacked near the Menin Road, advancing through Tower Hamlets under heavy mist to consolidate their objectives.

Memorial Site: Commemorated on the Tyne Cot Memorial, Belgium, on the exact same panels as Sydney Muckett (neither body was ever recovered).

Biographical information courtesy of the Stubbington and Hill Head History Society.

Time	Activity / Location	Details
Home	Stubbington Connection	Lived at Lower Crabthorne; Nurseryman
Memorial	Stubbington War Memorial	Commemorated in the village center.
Resting Place	Tyne Cot British Cemetery	Killed 26th September 1917 at Polygon Wood.

Lance Corporal A. Ward

Local Hero

Lance Corporal A. Ward

Service Number: 17568
Regiment: 15th (Hampshire Yeomanry) Battalion, The Hampshire Regiment
Born: 1896 in Alverstoke.

Local Connection: He was the son of Hugh Ward (a Royal Navy Coastguard and yacht steward) and Bertha Kathleen Ward. The family lived at 6 Coastguard Cottages, Hill Head, and later Balmoral, Gosport Road, Lee-on-the-Solent. His younger brother, Horace Vivian Ward, was also killed in action.

Military Service & Fate: Enlisted in Portsmouth. He fought on the Western Front, in Italy, and returned to France in March 1918. He was killed in action, aged 23, on **14th October 1918**—less than a month before the Armistice. During the final Allied advance from Gheluwe towards Courtrai, Belgium, his battalion advanced through thick mist under a harassing barrage to overcome German pillboxes.

Memorial Site: Commemorated on the Tyne Cot Memorial, Belgium (no known grave).

Biographical information courtesy of the Stubbington and Hill Head History Society.

Time	Activity / Location	Details
Home	Stubbington Connection	Lived at Balmoral, Gosport Road
Memorial	Stubbington War Memorial	Commemorated in the village center.
Resting Place	Tyne Cot British Cemetery	Killed 14th October 1918 advancing in thick mist.

Private C. Warland

Local Hero

Private C. Warland

Service Number: T/202335

Regiment: 3/4th Battalion, The Queen's (Royal West Surrey) Regiment

Born: 1897 at Richmond, Surrey.

Local Connection: He was the son of John Alfred Henry Warland (a sporting journalist, author, Secretary of the Lee-on-the-Solent Golf Club, and parish councillor) and Louise Clara Warland. The family lived at Canford, Lee-on-the-Solent.

Military Service & Fate: Enlisted in Richmond, Surrey. He was killed in action, aged 20, on **4th October 1917** during an assault south-east of Polygon Wood. His battalion advanced across the Polygonebeek marsh to capture Juniper Trench and a blockhouse under a continuous and heavy German artillery barrage.

Memorial Site: Commemorated on the Tyne Cot Memorial, Belgium (no known grave).

Biographical information courtesy of the Stubbington and Hill Head History Society.

Time	Activity / Location	Details
Home	Stubbington Connection	Lived at Canford
Memorial	Stubbington War Memorial	Commemorated in the village center.
Resting Place	Tyne Cot British Cemetery	Killed 4th October 1917 taking Juniper Trench.

Reflection & Synthesis

